

Modicum of Reality

Your forthright write-up on Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi should be an eye-opener for the media and all the political parties ("The Modi Method", January 7). Your efforts in educating them will be rewarded if all of them undergo a change.
S. R. CHANDE, on e-mail

Uneasy lies the head that wears the crown. Modi will now have to work extra hard to fulfil the expectations of the people, which are at an all-time high right now. He has a tough way ahead considering the fact that all his movements will be dissected in great detail.
RUMIN SHAH, Vadodara

The people of Gujarat rejected the Congress since they did not have any prominent leader to fall back on. Most of their poll strategies backfired and the issues of terrorism and secularism did not cut any ice with the voters. We should not read too much into Modi's triumph. It is doubtful whether Moditva would work anywhere else.
D.B.N. MURTHY, Bangalore

In the age of terrorism, a merchant of death (Modi) is far more acceptable than a merchant of dreams (Sonia Gandhi).
VIJAY DANDIWALA, on e-mail

Modi is an uncomfortable word for secular pundits since he refused to issue a licence for bottled baptism to be used exclusively in tribal India with 100 per cent Western investment.
C.P. NARENDRA, Nagpur

Celestial on Celluloid

Taare Zameen Par is a wonderful film ("All Star Simplicity", January 7). It should be screened in all schools and colleges across the country. Thank you Mr Aamir Khan for giving us such a wonderful film.
BHARATRAM GABA, Mumbai

Politics of Conversion

Though a lot has been written about the violence in Kandhmal, nobody has bothered to delve deeper

into the issue ("Faith Attack", January 7). The people there live in abject poverty, which makes them easy prey for the missionaries, who not only indulge in conversions, but also try to widen the rift between the converts and the non-converts. The demand for reservation by those converted is illegitimate considering that they get a lot of benefits from the missionaries. The Government should look into the matter.
J.N. MAHANTY, Puri

DYNASTIC POLITICS UNDER A DICTATOR



One fails to understand how Benazir Bhutto, who had promised democracy to Pakistan, could name a political greenhorn like Bilawal Zardari her successor and leave him at the hands of her corrupt husband, Asif Ali Zardari ("Life After Death", January 14).

VANI A., Hyderabad

The upcoming elections will prove to be the toughest battle not only for President Pervez Musharraf, who has been losing ground among his people, but for the Americans as well, who have been supporting the former army chief in all his deeds.

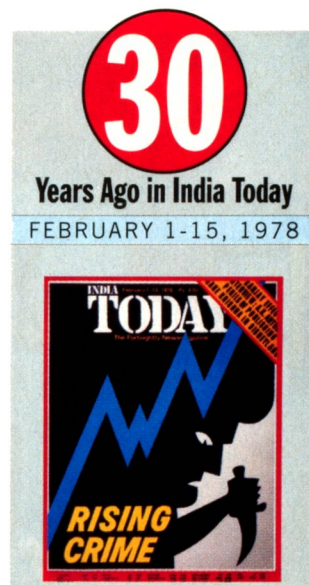
BAL GOVIND, Bareilly

Bilawal being elevated to the post of PPP chairman is yet another case of dynasty politics that has haunted South Asia for long.

J.S. ACHARYA, Hyderabad

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Crime and Politics

Delhi's crime rate, among the highest in the country, has shown an alarming increase in the recent months. Of the 175 murders in 1977, 116 remain unsolved. Eve teasing, which had almost disappeared during the Emergency, has reappeared with a vengeance. With street crime on an increase, organised crime is also back in operation. And a thoroughly demoralised Delhi Police force seems unable to stem the tide. The feeling of uncertainty and insecurity has intensified by the lack of a positive policy for restructuring the Delhi Police. Home Minister Charan Singh—behaving similar to an Emergency overlord—recently ordered a rash of arrests, suspensions and transfers as part of a clean-up operation of the city Police. He has inadvertently brought out the worst in them. From the constable to the IGP, they work themselves to a frenzy to pay court to their new masters.



—Prabhu Chawla

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